

MOST HAPPENING, FACT-FILLED CURRENT AFFAIRS FROM AROUND THE WORLD

Charge mobile by sending SMS

Running out on your phone's battery? Now all you need to do is to send an SMS to recharge it. Buffalo Grid has developed a solar-powered cellphone charging station that gets activated by an SMS. The system can be beneficial for people living off-grid as recharging their phone is now an SMS away.

The company has designed the technology particularly for rural areas in the developing parts of the world like Africa and Asia. According to a 'NewScientist' report, a trial of the technology has already been conducted in Uganda. The technology works in a way that the battery of the cellphone derives its power from a solar panel via a technique called maximum power point tracking (MPPT). The battery, via this unique technique, is charged by a 60-watt solar panel.

Self-driving robot car

You might have heard about Google's driverless car—a project by Google that involves developing technology for driverless cars. Now, a team of researchers at the Oxford University has come up with a new technology, recently tested on the UK roads by the Mobile Robotics Group, that could turn out to be a low-cost alternative to Google's driverless cars.

Using its technology the car is able



Self-driving RobotCar

to accelerate, brake and drive itself along familiar routes through a combination of navigation, planning and control algorithms developed as part of the Oxford Robotcar UK project, said a report by The Inquirer.

To test the technology, the team used a modified Nissan Leaf car. The adapted Nissan Leaf's navigation system offers the ability to recognise its surroundings using small cameras and laser rangefinders built into the body.

Here comes Yeti - a guide robot

Travelling to Antarctica? 'Yeti,' a guide robot, can help you with a fun-filled



Robot Yeti tells you where not to go in Antarctica

adventure guiding you through the proper paths. You might find the snow in Antarctica nice and smooth looking but it is likely to have several meters deep crevasses, so moving from one place to another on the ground could be potentially deadly. With an aim to address this challenge, engineers from Dartmouth College in Hanover, N.H., have developed a GPS-guided robot called 'Yeti.'

Equipped with sensors, the robot can easily

detect dangerous crevasses and find an alternate path.

He-Man Robopark

He-Man Engineers has developed a multi-level automatic parking system called He-Man Robopark. The recently launched system, which uses robotic technology, was designed at the company's manufacturing facility at Angamally near Kochi and uses an Irish technology adapted for the Indian environs, said a Business Line report.

Tenny Jose, chairman and managing director of Tenny Jose and Associates, said that the system will be installed at a leading automobile showroom in Thrissur soon.

"A Robopark tower enables a business firm to park up to 160 SUVs in 10 cents of land, thereby saving at least 50 per cent land as compared to conventional parking ramps. Power failures will not affect its operations due to

an in-built electricity generation," the report added.

Crash-proof computer

Ever imagined a computer that never crashes? Well, you don't need to imagine that any more. Computer scientists at the University College London (UCL) have come up with a self-repairing, inspired-by-nature computer that never crashes.

"This technology could find its way into mission-critical systems that must not fail, or it could improve the overall reliability of computers in general—which is a good thing, considering how almost everything we interact with is governed by a digital computer," said a report by Extreme Tech.